🪖 World War I: Poster Activity · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 7 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · WWI propaganda posters

Name: _____

These posters are from the Library of Congress "Free to Use" WWI set. Work with a partner.

Analyze the posters (Library of Congress, free to use)

1



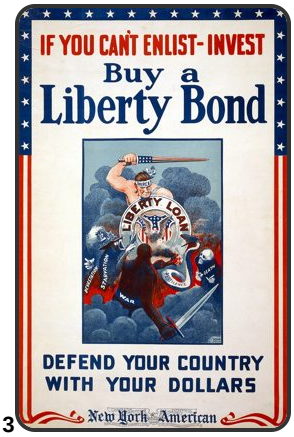
"I Want You for U.S. Army"

2



"Food Will Win the War"

3



"If You Can't Enlist, Invest: Buy a Liberty Bond"

4



"Gee!! I Wish I Were a Man, I'd Join the Navy"

1. Fill in the table.

#	Title / artist	Message (in your words)	Action wanted	Technique (emotion, guilt, patriotism, symbol)
1	"I Want You for U.S. Army" · James Montgomery Flagg, 1917	**Join the army. Uncle Sam (the U.S.) is asking YOU personally.**	**Enlist as a soldier**	**Direct point + Uncle Sam symbol (patriotism)**
2	"Food Will Win the War" · U.S. Food Administration, 1917	**Immigrants found freedom here; now help protect it by not wasting wheat.**	**Save food; waste nothing**	**Statue of Liberty symbol; duty/guilt**
3	**"If You Can't Enlist, Invest: Buy a Liberty Bond" · Winsor McCay, 1917–1918**	**If you can't fight, lend your money to the government to pay for the war.**	**Buy Liberty Bonds**	**Patriotism, symbol of Liberty fighting**
4	**"Gee!! I Wish I Were a Man, I'd Join the Navy" · Howard Chandler Christy, 1917**	**Even this young woman wants to serve, so men should join the Navy.**	**Join the Navy**	**Guilt/shame aimed at men; an attractive figure**

Discuss with your partner

2. How did the government expect the average citizen to contribute to the war effort?
Enlist, buy Liberty Bonds, save food (wheat, meat), work in war jobs, support the troops.

3. Which poster is your favorite, and which is most effective? Explain why for each.
Answers vary; must give reasons tied to images or words.

4. Why might propaganda be dangerous as well as helpful?
It can unite people, but it can also spread fear, hide the truth or turn people against groups (e.g., German Americans).

🔑 *Key written by our team, please check.*